



# EFFORT

PREPOSITIONS



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# EFFORT

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## INTRODUCTION

There are people that enjoy success thanks to some luck. Unfortunately for them, luck tends not to be something you can rely on for too long. Effort, on the other hand, is fully reliable and is a sure fire attribute of a constantly successful event planner. Yes, there are a number of other important elements to their character but applying a good work ethic to the perceived magic will be what makes it stand out from the rest.

So, what is effort? According to the Merriam-Webster dictionary it is, in the context we are discussing, the ‘conscious exertion of power or hard work’ and ‘the total work done to achieve a particular end.’ In our normal working lives, we do and see this all the time.

That friend who makes it to the gym every morning before going to the office. Your nephew who is studying instead of playing to make sure he gets the qualifications he wants. The colleague who is maintaining a healthy diet focused on reaching a desired shape before the summer holidays. A patient following a daily plan to recover from an illness. All of these people are determined, and their efforts have one important thing in





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common: a final goal. Whether it's fitness, health, career, happiness or whatever else, aiming for a particular objective is often the key to effective effort. Instant gratification may be a modern desire, but a foundation of effort is what will prove successful and most fulfilling.

When setting out the plans for a new event you will line up a number of specific objectives that will define its success. Striving to achieve them is the effort that you will use. That effort will manifest itself through a number of your skills: creativity, organization, negotiation, delegation, communication... and will be maintained throughout the life of the project. Obstacles will undoubtedly be thrown into your path, questions about the choices you make will be raised, and sometimes you'll feel completely overwhelmed. But your determination will mean that each day you wake up and get take the next steps towards reaching the end goals.

Planning a meeting or event is rarely an easy task, however, as any professional that has delivered a successful one can contest, the effort is certainly worth it.



## SPEAKING

What does effort mean for you?



## GRAMMAR – the basic ones – PREPOSITIONS with TIME

| AT           |               |                             | IN              |                              |                                              |
|--------------|---------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Precise time | 5 O'clock     |                             | Longer periods  | Months                       | January<br>February<br>I see you in February |
|              | Midnight      | She left at midnight        |                 | Seasons                      | Winter<br>Spring                             |
|              | Lunch time    |                             |                 | Years                        | 2029<br>2030                                 |
|              | Present       |                             |                 | The past                     |                                              |
| Or...        | Weekend       |                             | After some time | The 21 <sup>st</sup> century |                                              |
|              | Christmas     | Shall we meet at Christmas? |                 | Seven seconds                |                                              |
|              | Night         |                             |                 | Nine months                  | You welcome a baby in nine months            |
|              | The moment    |                             |                 | Six days' time               |                                              |
|              | The same time |                             | Or...           | The morning                  | He has a shower in the morning               |
|              |               |                             |                 | The afternoon                |                                              |
|              |               |                             |                 | The evening                  |                                              |



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| ON    |                            |                                              | No prepositions |                                |
|-------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------|
| Days  | Monday                     | The meeting is on Monday                     | Last year       |                                |
|       | Tuesday                    |                                              | Next Friday     |                                |
| Dates | 21 <sup>st</sup> June 2023 | It will happen on 21 <sup>st</sup> June 2023 | Next weekend    | What will you do next weekend? |
|       | 15 <sup>th</sup> May       |                                              | This month      |                                |
|       |                            |                                              | Every Thursday  |                                |



## EXERCISE 1 – Grammar: Prepositions with Time.

Put in the correct preposition (choose in / on / at). If no preposition is needed put in "--".

- 1) There was a loud noise which woke us up \_\_\_\_\_ midnight.
- 2) Do you usually eat chocolate eggs \_\_\_\_\_ Easter?
- 3) What are you doing \_\_\_\_\_ the weekend?
- 4) \_\_\_\_\_ last week I worked until 9pm \_\_\_\_\_ every night.
- 5) My father always reads the paper \_\_\_\_\_ breakfast time.
- 6) She plays tennis \_\_\_\_\_ Fridays.
- 7) The trees here are really beautiful \_\_\_\_\_ the spring.
- 8) I'll see you \_\_\_\_\_ Tuesday afternoon then.
- 9) Shakespeare died \_\_\_\_\_ 1616.
- 10) She studies \_\_\_\_\_ every day.
- 11) John is going to buy the presents \_\_\_\_\_ today.
- 12) In my hometown, the shops open early \_\_\_\_\_ the morning.
- 13) She met her husband \_\_\_\_\_ 1998.
- 14) The party is \_\_\_\_\_ next Saturday.
- 15) We are meeting \_\_\_\_\_ Friday morning.
- 16) I often get sleepy \_\_\_\_\_ the afternoon.
- 17) His daughter was born the \_\_\_\_\_ 24th of August.
- 18) Mobile phones became popular \_\_\_\_\_ the nineties.
- 19) Luckily the weather was perfect \_\_\_\_\_ her wedding day.



EFFORT

## GRAMMAR – ADJECTIVES FOR EFFORT

| ENGLISH       | SPANISH      |
|---------------|--------------|
| Abortive      | Abortivo     |
| Clumsy        | Torpe        |
| Conscientious | Conciencioso |
| Consistent    | Constante    |
| Constant      | Constante    |
| Co-Operative  | Cooperativo  |
| Desperate     | Desesperado  |
| Determined    | Decidido     |
| Eruptive      | Eruptivo     |
| Frightened    | Asustado     |
| Further       | Más          |
| Great         | Grandioso    |
| Intellectual  | Intelectual  |
| Last          | Última       |
| Mere          | Mero         |
| Much          | Mucho        |
| Needed        | Necesario    |
| Organized     | Organizado   |

| ENGLISH    | SPANISH      |
|------------|--------------|
| Outrageous | Escandaloso  |
| Painful    | Doloroso     |
| Persistent | Persistente  |
| Physical   | Físico       |
| Pitiful    | Lamentable   |
| Possible   | Posible      |
| Powerful   | Potente      |
| Same       | El mismo     |
| Serious    | Serio        |
| Slight     | Leve         |
| Strong     | Fuerte       |
| Stupendous | Estupendo    |
| Supreme    | Supremo      |
| Tremendous | Tremendo     |
| Unwilling  | Sin voluntad |
| Valiant    | Valiente     |
| Worthwhile | Digno        |
| Wrong      | Equivocado   |

### SENTENCES - EXAMPLES

1. The inadequacy of the analyses already offered should not discourage **further effort** in this direction.
2. Even then it was with no **slight effort** that he restrained the girl's fury.
3. What is war if it isn't a consistent effort to exterminate the enemy?
4. The waitress brought them tea and the orchestra flung itself into a more **outrageous effort** than before.
5. If he did, why didn't he make some **further effort** to talk with her?
6. He picked it up, made a **clumsy effort** to comfort it, and, not knowing what else to do, sat down beside it.
7. The greatest achievement of the order is that it has taught the farmers of America the value of co-operation and the power of **organized effort**.
8. Adelle cranked her car feverishly and succeeded at last, after **much effort**, in starting the engine and in pushing back the garage door.
9. Involuntarily Dulce has covered her eyes with her hand, and by a supreme effort has suppressed the cry that has risen from her heart.
10. This strength of will was not, as is generally supposed, inherited by him; he was born without it, and acquired it by a **tremendous effort**.



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11. Maggie made a **supreme effort** to reply in a controlled voice: "Just a minute.
12. Every fine day the dwellers in the trenches before Bapaume saw machines swerving round each other in **determined effort** to destroy.
13. The child never stirred from his place, but she noticed that he made a **constant effort** to entertain Robin.
14. By a **strong effort** he controlled himself, the old look of determination came back into his eyes, and he spoke more like his normal self.
15. Disheartened and despondent over this **abortive effort**, I opened the door again, and went up to my room.
16. His pride is awakened, he would hate to fail, or to disappoint them, so he makes a **conscientious effort** to be worthy and to succeed.
17. But my **constant effort** proved unsuccessful; and the said passage in Hebrews often recurred to my mind.
18. He bowed his head and asked pardon of God because he had dared to sacrifice in that **last effort** the lives of many others.
19. With a **great effort** of self-control, however, she changed her mind and threw herself into his easy-chair with a little gesture of recklessness.
20. In several decades of **painful effort**, French diplomacy has solved the problem in brilliant fashion.
21. Ill-success failed to crush us: the **mere effort** to succeed had given a wonderful zest to existence; it must be pursued.
22. She made a valiant effort not to speak; but to hear Rupert abused was like dragging her through fire.
23. Like everything else of his authorship this building represented a **determined effort** to lend the town an air of Eastern elegance.
24. Sir Hilton nodded again, and then made a **desperate effort** to turn the conversation back upon his friend.
25. Many of these are, of course, formed to undertake some definite work, to achieve some end which can only be achieved by **co-operative effort**.
26. However, with a **stupendous effort** Betty now summoned her courage, of which the shock of the moment had robbed her.
27. They looked at the rooms; they stood gazing pensively at their trunks; it seemed too cold to make the **physical effort** to unpack their clothes.
28. He walked only with the aid of a cane, and then, apparently, with **great effort**, stopping frequently to rest.
29. Then, as though by a **great effort**, overcoming his reluctance for the waste of words, he displayed an almost unexpected urbanity.
30. When singing songs, however, they do not show, at least not nearly as much as wrong breathing and **wrong effort**.
31. Then an army was landed on the Gallipoli peninsula, and a desperate effort was made to take the forts from the rear.





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32. Without attempting to go around it, he grasped the edge, and, by a **determined effort**, drew himself upon it.
33. But he was keen enough to see that, like his coveted riches, the **needed effort** to gain her affection added to the intensity of his desire.
34. Making a **supreme effort**, she got in; and then, neither dreams nor waking thoughts, but oblivion complete.
35. Again, every **possible effort** should be made to encourage habits of thrift, and to provide satisfactory modes of investment for small savings.
36. Police and firemen battered their way through, ran down and over men, women, and children, with a **desperate effort**.
37. Valerie leaned back against the door, hands clasped behind her, eyebrows bent slightly inward in an **unwilling effort** to remember.
38. It must be now or never, for it was clear to him that the men were making their last effort, and the boilers would not bear another pound of steam.
39. With one **powerful effort** he sent the foreman whirling through the open door into the hall, slammed the door after him, and stood shaking.
40. It's the mixture of physical and **intellectual effort** which makes the attraction, I imagine.
41. Without any **further effort** to detain Channing, she walked to the stairs and up them, her chin still high.
42. Somehow that seemed to make her matter less, and Dodo had not at present made any **determined effort** to beleaguer her.
43. A week, however, was too short a time in which to cover the ground, but by **persistent effort** on our part much was accomplished.
44. At other social levels, he knew, there was the same closing of the shutters, the same effort to create an enjoyable sunlight in a cloistered room.
45. The enemy had made a **determined effort** to retake Moeuvres, and our right flank was just on the edge of his attack.
46. If useful at all, it will, we apprehend, be in the forming stage of the disease, before the skin is altered by the **eruptive effort**.
47. A **frightened effort** to regain her self-control, and her voice broke in something like a sob, while tears trembled on her lashes.
48. There is an abundance of humour, quaint situations, and **worth-while effort**, and likewise plenty of plot and mystery.
49. Baptiste made a pitiful effort to follow her, but his weary limbs were unable to bear the strain any longer, and he fell unconscious to the floor.
50. There is an irksomeness, a restlessness, a pervading dissatisfaction, together with an absolute incapacity to bend the mind to any **serious effort**.



## WRITING

FCE Writing Essay. Part 1.

Difficulty level: B2 /Upper Intermediate





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Write 140-190 words in an appropriate style. (Try to use as many adjectives as possible from the above list)

Some people think success is everything. For others, happiness is all they need. In your opinion, what's more important, success or happiness?

### Notes

Write about:

1 Money

2 Stress

3 ..... (Your own idea)



### PRONUNCIATION – Jamie's Goals

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rjdZHP3NL8k>



Read the story at the same time you are listening to. Try to concentrate on the pronunciation.



### SPEAKING

What are your current goals?





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## SPEAKING & READING - GOALS

Your goals become a lot less daunting when you focus on the smaller, more accessible steps you need to take to achieve them.

Believe me, I feel overwhelmed in the little things I have to do day-to-day. I'm constantly reminding myself to take things just one step at a time. It makes everything manageable.



"What are your life goals?" is one of those questions that can put people in an uncomfortable position pretty quickly. Most answer this question by laughing it off and responding with something like "eating pizza with no pants on while watching Netflix - that's what I really want."

The thing is, nobody wants to take the time to write down their life goals. People live busy lives, and when they do have the time, they'd rather kick it in front of the TV or lay on the couch playing with their phones.

What exactly are life goals? Simply put, they're the things you would like to accomplish in your life. Life goals are the big things to work for and accomplish such as getting married and having a family, starting your own business, becoming a big-time executive, or traveling the globe. Life goals are essentially everything you want to do in life before passing on. They're the stuff people remember you by when you are no longer around.

Why are goals so important? Setting goals gives you purpose, and they help you to guide your life. Think of life goals as your North Star. They'll guide you where you want to go, but it's still on you to choose the path to get there.

Even if you've already gone through a similar exercise as I'm about to describe, try not to brush off the following activity just yet. Maybe it's been a while and some of your goals have changed. Maybe there's a few more things you really want that eluded you before. It may be worth it to go through and rework your plan a bit.

**Let's dive in by working in groups. We are going to follow these next steps:**



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## 1. Brainstorming your life goals

Find a quiet place to sit and work on this section for 5-10 minutes. If you find yourself hitting a roadblock, try getting up and going for a walk, or perhaps taking a shower. Some of my most inspirational thinking has come from my time spent in the shower.

Think about everything in your life that is really important to you. Think about the couple of things you've really been pondering lately or your biggest struggle in life.

There are plenty of areas of your life you can set life goals in: careers, family, friends, other relationships, schooling, spirituality, traveling, fun, charity, money, health, and many more.

These are just some to get your brain churning. Write down anything and everything that comes to mind - all of the things you'd like to accomplish and those that sound fun or exhilarating to you.

## 2. Setting your life goals

The things you come up with during this exercise, by no means, have to be your definitive life goals for the rest of your life. As I said before, people change and so does what's important to them. Just try to focus on the things that are important to you currently.

Look at what you've written down from your brainstorming session. Narrow that list down to the things you absolutely couldn't live without doing - those are your life goals.



Next try to clarify each of your goals with a specific target and a clearly defined outcome. You should be able to picture what your life will be like when you achieve the goal. Pat yourself on the back for identifying what's truly important to you.

## 3. Building a plan to achieve them



Once your goals are defined, the next step is creating a plan to get there. Many life coaches recommend using the Simpleology system devised by Mark Joyner. It's called backward planning and is a method used by the US military.

To summarize, think about the last step needed to accomplish just one of your goals. If climbing Mount Everest was on your list, then literally your last footstep onto the summit should be what comes to mind.

Before that, you'll need to come up with a team to do it with, a conditioning regimen to prepare yourself, travel plans, and much more. Work all the way backwards until you land on the first step that you need to take. It should be something actionable and achievable in the very near-term.

If you've done the exercise correctly and wrote everything down along the way, you'll have a step-by-step plan for exactly what's needed to accomplish your goal. The rest is making it happen.



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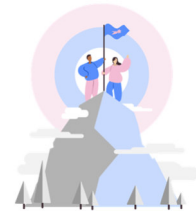
#### 4. Getting after it

Once you've planned out each one of your life goals, you may feel slightly intimidated, and that's okay. After all, these are your life's biggest accomplishments to-be. The best way to start checking them off your list is to work on them one at a time.

Let me repeat. One at a time.

Choose just one of the things you'd like to accomplish, preferably the one that's most important to you right now, and put your plan into action. Start adding the steps you drew out in the previous exercise onto your calendar and deciding when you're going to take each step.

If your goal is something that's going to take several years to accomplish, what can you do this year to get that much closer? What can you do in the next few months?



Your goals become a lot less daunting when you focus on the smaller, more accessible steps you need to take to achieve them. Believe me, I feel overwhelmed in the little things I have to do day-to-day. I'm constantly reminding myself to take things just one step at a time. It makes everything manageable.

Once you've got all of your preparation done, it's on you to go after it. Remember to choose just one life goal and focus as much energy as you can into it. If it's something you truly desire, then motivation shouldn't be a problem.







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## SPEAKING

What are your goals **in your life**? Let's work in groups and draw your own map.





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## **EXERCISE 2 – Grammar: adjectives and prepositions.**

Complete the sentences using the words in bold. **Use two to five words.**

1) Ms Roberts is well-known because of the funny stories she writes.

### **FAMOUS**

Ms Roberts is \_\_\_\_\_ the funny stories she writes.

2) Have you ever heard the legend of King Arthur?

### **FAMILIAR**

Are \_\_\_\_\_ the legend of King Arthur?

3) She maybe 46, but she can run a marathon in under four hours.

### **CAPABLE**

She maybe 46, but she \_\_\_\_\_ a marathon in under four hours.

4) John is showing a lot of interest in buying Susan's laptop.

### **VERY**

John seems \_\_\_\_\_ buying Susan's laptop.

5) I'd like to thank your sister for her help.

### **GRATEFUL**

I am very \_\_\_\_\_ her help.

6) I had no idea that a famous musician was born in the village.

### **UNAWARE**

I \_\_\_\_\_ fact that a famous musician was born in the village.



## GRAMMAR – SOME ADJECTIVES WITH PREPOSITIONS

### **AT**

We use “at” with adjectives like good/bad/amazing/brilliant/terrible, etc. to talk about skills and abilities.

He's really **good at** English.

She's **amazing at** the piano.

They're **terrible at** organising anything.

I'm not very **good at** drawing.



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### ABOUT

We often use “about” with adjectives of feelings like angry/excited/happy/nervous/sad/stressed/worried, etc. to explain what is causing that feeling.

I'm **angry about** the decision.

He's **nervous about** the presentation.

She's **excited about** the new job.

They were **worried about** the exam.

### OF

However, sometimes we use “of” with feelings.

She was **afraid of** telling her mum.

I'm **frightened of** having an accident.

He's **scared of** flying.

You should be **proud of** your progress.

### TO

We can use “to” to show the connection between people or things.

He's **married to** the director.

I'm **addicted to** my phone.

I'm **allergic to** nuts.

It's **similar to** the old one.

We can also use “to” to talk about someone's behaviour towards someone else.

They were really **friendly to** me.

Was he **nice to** you?

He is always **polite to** everyone.

She was very **rude to** the waitress.

Here are some other useful adjectives with prepositions.

### FOR

Exercise is **good for** you.

Stress is **bad for** you.

The town is **famous for** its cheese.

I'm **responsible for** the financial side of the business.

### IN

She's **interested in** the project.

They want someone who's **experienced in** design.

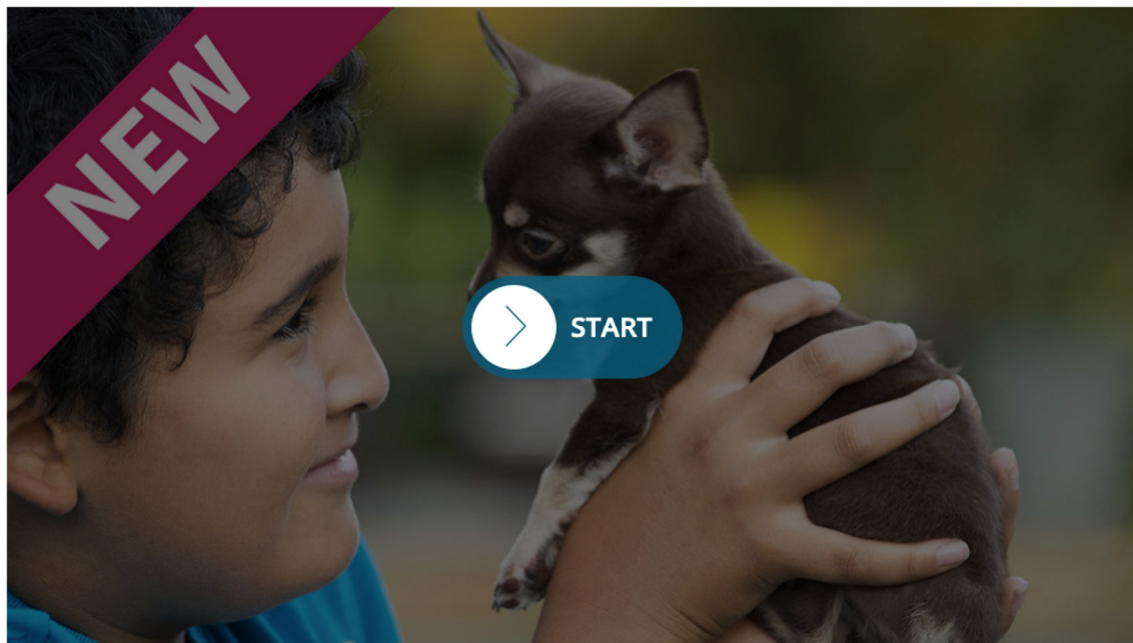
I didn't want to get **involved in** the argument.





## EXERCISE 3 – Grammar: prepositions used with adjectives.

<https://www.cambridgeenglish.org/learning-english/activities-for-learners/a2g051-prepositions-used-with-adjectives>

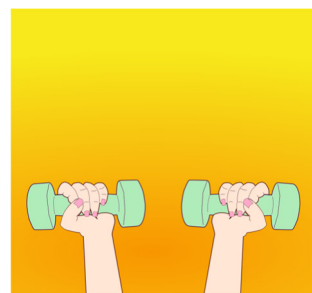


### THE POWER OF EFFORT

Everything that we want to achieve requires some effort. But how important is effort in achieving our goals?

What you do today – the effort you put in – determines your success tomorrow. Rory Vaden, the author of “Take the Stairs: 7 Steps for Achieving True Success”, says, “Success is never owned; it is only rented – and the rent is due every day.”

Effort, like sunscreen in the summer, needs to be applied consistently. To achieve our goals, we need to put in the effort each and every day. On days that we feel good and on days when we don't feel like doing the work. Many people will put in effort for a short time and when their effort does not immediately pay off or they become distracted by life, they stop putting in the daily effort needed to finish and succeed.



One way to keep yourself motivated to put in the effort needed for your goals is to think of all the other people who have the same goal. Knowing that most people will at some point give up and stop putting in consistent effort, you can use this to motivate you to continue to work hard and keep moving forward. I call these “Get ahead” days. These are the days that you get ahead of your competition. After all, everyone can put in the effort when they are feeling good or the circumstances are perfect, but not many persist through the tough days.



## EFFORT



Effort is really just a habit that we need to develop if we want to be successful. Success requires that you are willing to do whatever is necessary, when it is necessary in order to succeed.

Effort pays off in many ways. When we put in effort, we learn. Whether the effort produces results or not, we can learn and adapt based on what we learn from our efforts. If our efforts lead us further away from our goal, then we need to change our strategy. If our effort brings us closer to our goal, we can double down with our effort.

The great basketball player, Michael Jordan said that work ethic, (effort), eliminates fear. By putting in the effort, we know what we are capable of and do not need to be afraid.

Effort teaches us that we can do more than we thought. We learn new skills and abilities when we take the time to put in consistent effort. Every new success that we achieve through our efforts increases our confidence in ourselves and our abilities. Effort keeps us focused on success. As your effort brings you closer to your goal, your motivation and willpower increase as you can taste victory.



## SPEAKING

What effort do you find most difficult to make?